

Functional English

Exercise 1: Vocabulary Building through Context Clues (total marks: 10)

Instructions: Read each sentence and use the context of the sentence to guess the meaning of the underlined word. Choose the correct meaning of the unfamiliar word from the provided options.

1. The river's **serpentine** path through the valley made it a popular spot for kayaking and canoeing.

A. steep
B. winding or curving
C. dangerous
D. wide

2. Maria had a **propensity** for helping others, often volunteering her time at local charities.

A. fear
B. talent
C. tendency
D. ambition

3. The detective's **meticulous** investigation led to the discovery of critical evidence that solved the case.

A. careful and precise
B. speedy and reckless
C. lazy and disorganised
D. hasty and incomplete

4. The **ubiquitous** presence of smartphones means that people are almost always connected to the internet.

A. rare

- B. widespread
- C. expensive
- D. old-fashioned

5. The teacher's **jovial** demeanour made the classroom a lively and enjoyable place for learning.

- A. strict
- B. cheerful and friendly
- C. unpredictable
- D. serious and sombre

6. The travellers were captivated by the **panorama** of snow-capped mountains and crystal-clear lakes.

- A. fast food
- B. scenic view
- C. mountain range
- D. traffic jam

7. The **vexing** puzzle seemed impossible at first, but with patience and perseverance, they solved it.

- A. frustrating
- B. entertaining
- C. boring
- D. colourful

8. The **ephemeral** beauty of a rainbow appeared in the sky after the brief rain shower.

- A. long-lasting
- B. lasting for a very short time
- C. permanent
- D. colourful

9. Sarah's **gregarious** nature made it easy for her to strike up conversations with strangers and make new friends.

- A. outgoing and sociable
- B. shy and reserved
- C. quiet and introverted
- D. mean and unpleasant

10. The **indomitable** spirit of the athlete allowed her to overcome any obstacle in her path to success.

- A. easily defeated
- B. unbeatable and determined
- C. weak and disheartened
- D. inconsistent and unreliable

Exercise 2

(5 Marks)

Read the following passage and answer the questions.

The aroma of freshly baked bread **wafted** through the air as patrons entered the cozy bakery. The display case showcased an array of delectable pastries, from delicate macarons to rich chocolate **éclairs**. The owner, a culinary **maestro**, worked diligently in the kitchen, creating confections with precision and flair. Customers sipped on aromatic coffee, engaging in lively discussions about the latest art exhibit at the nearby gallery. The atmosphere was **suffused** with an ambiance of creativity and **conviviality**.

Question 1: In the passage, what does "wafted" mean?

- A. Strongly scented
- B. Floating gently through the air
- C. Vanishing quickly

Question 2: What are "éclairs" as mentioned in the passage?

- A. Delicate pastries

- B. Coffee beverages
- C. Art exhibits

Question 3: Based on the passage, what does "maestro" mean?

- A. An artist's studio
- B. A musical composition
- C. A person highly skilled in an art or craft

Question 4: What is the meaning of "suffused" in the context of the passage?

- A. Completely filled
- B. Overwhelmed by smells
- C. Disorganized

Question 5: In the passage, what is the meaning of "conviviality"?

- A. Seriousness and solemnity
- B. Warmth and friendliness
- C. Darkness and mystery